



Financial Operations Control: Moving Beyond Enterprise DMS

Securing SME workflows through canonical
document control and verifiable identity.

The SME Dilemma: Caught Between Chaos and Complexity



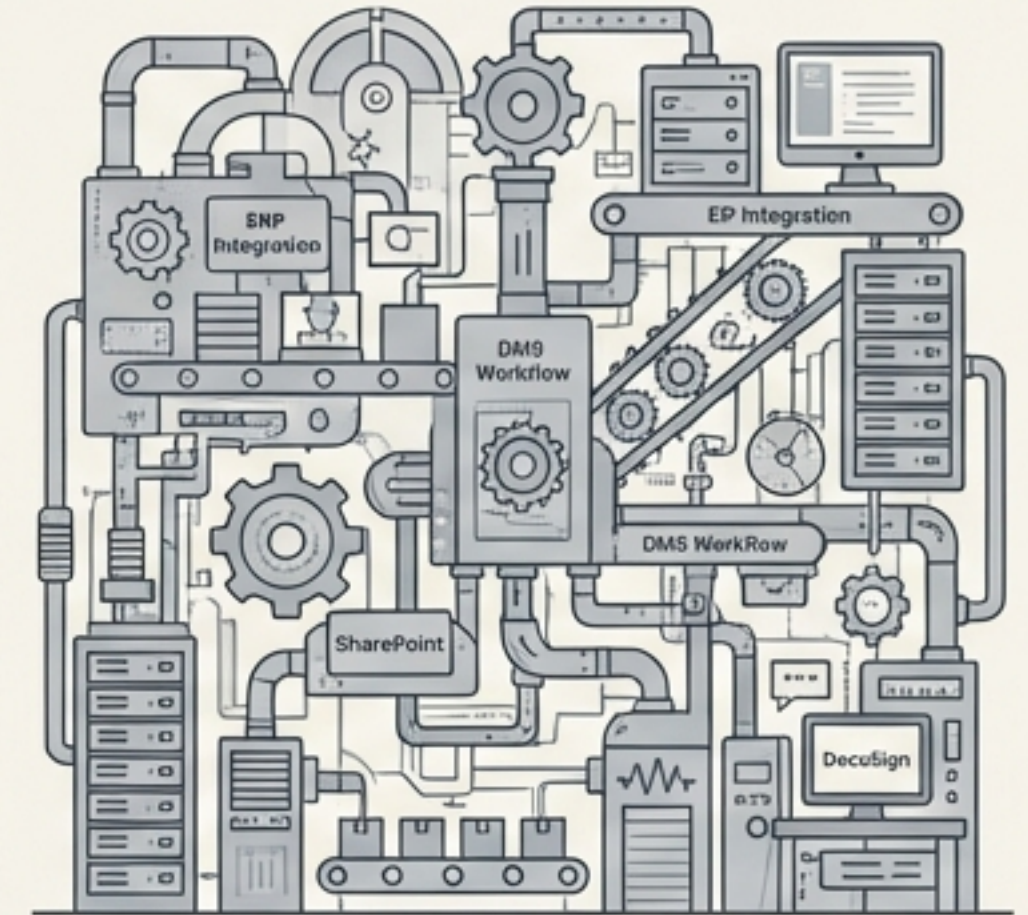
Manual / Email

Widespread manual processes. Free, but dominated by messy workflows and high fraud risk.



The Sweet Spot

A targeted approach for mid-size companies. Solving multi-million-pound risks for a fraction of enterprise costs (£1/GB, credit-based).



Enterprise ERP / DMS

Solutions like SharePoint or DocuSign. Clunky, over-engineered, and costing £10,000 to £100,000 annually.

The Core Insight: Identity and Control Drive Security

When designing solutions for financial operations, the priority isn't just encryption. It's absolute certainty about origin, access, and truth.



Who sent it.

Verifiable sender identity ensures an invoice arrived from the supplier, not a fraudster (PKI signing).



Who can read it.

Guaranteeing only intended recipients can open the document (Public-key encryption).



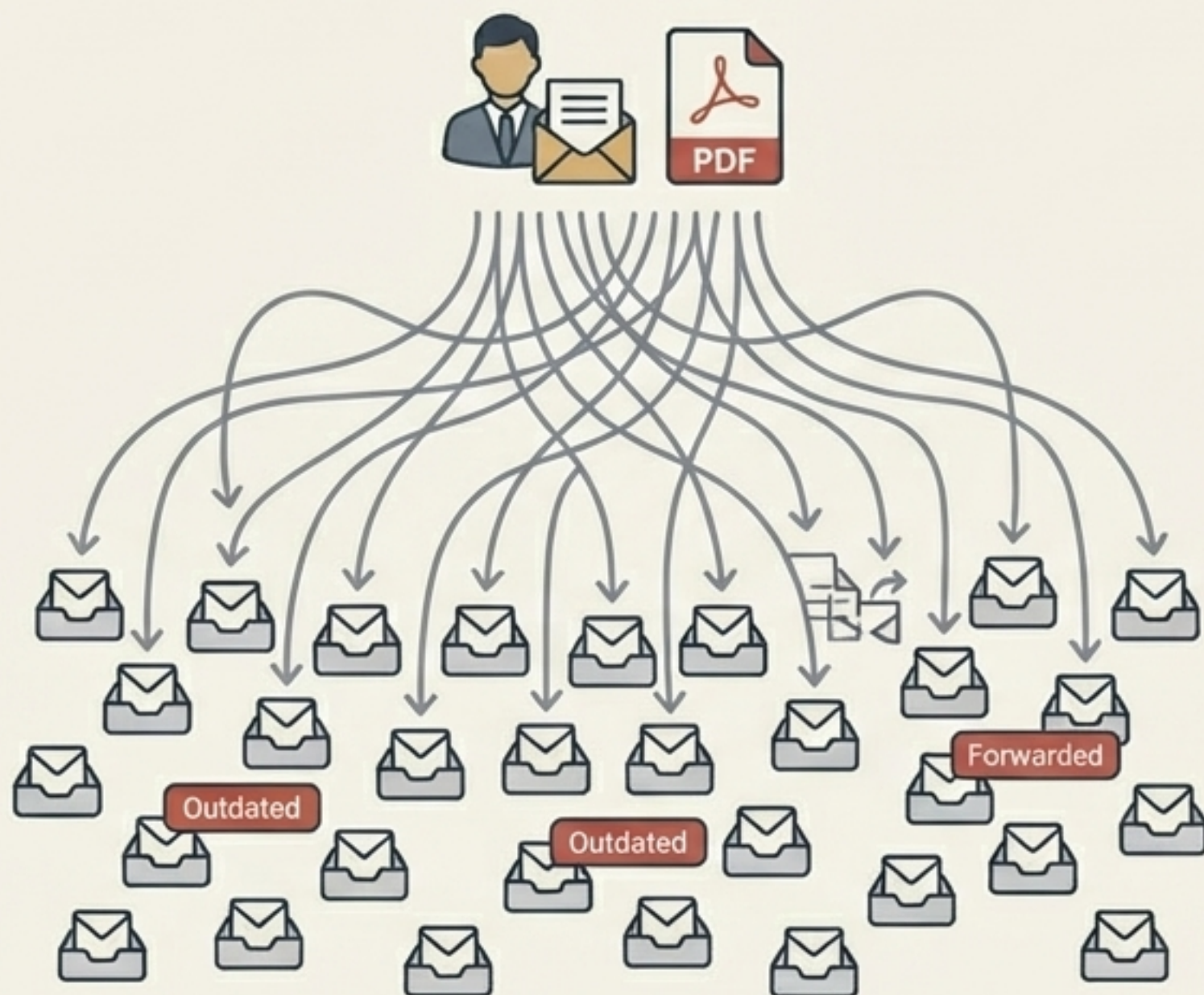
Which version is live.

Eradicating scattered inbox copies to ensure everyone views the exact same data (Single-link model).

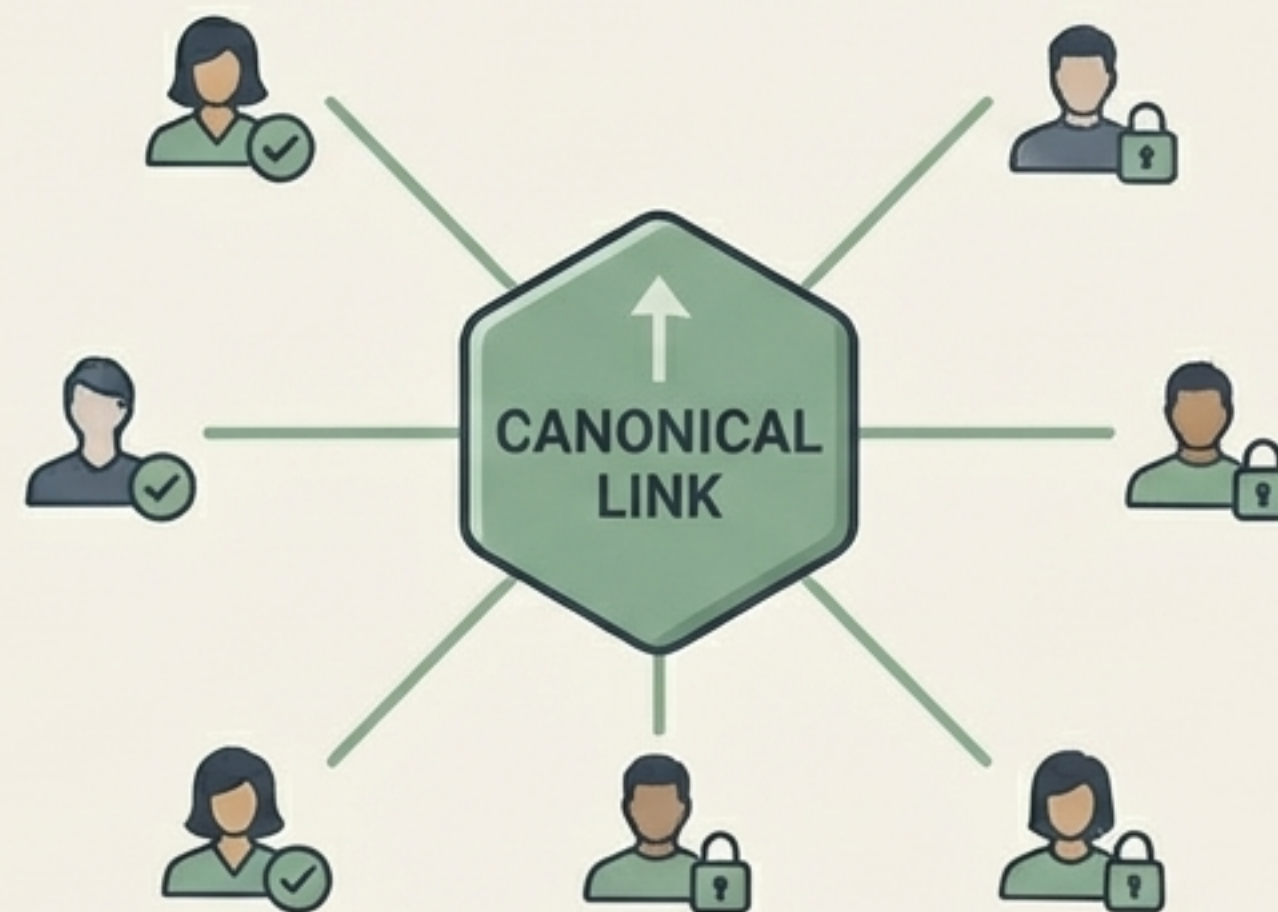
The Power of the Canonical Version

One link. One truth. You control who sees it.

The Old Way



The SG/Send Way



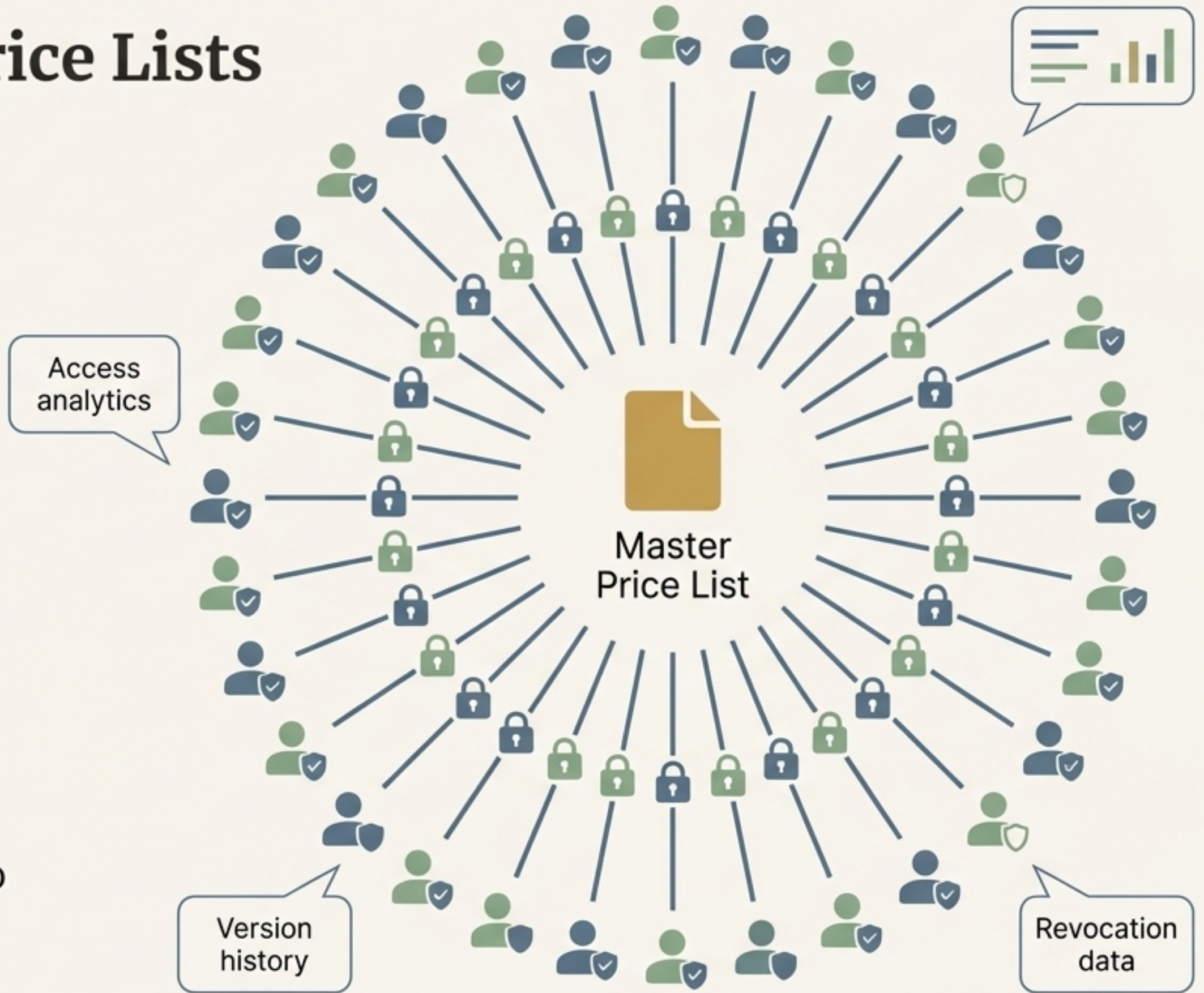
- Instant link revocation (no please delete emails)
- Real-time access analytics
- Seamless version updates behind the exact same link

Use Case 1: Partner Price Lists

Distributing pricing to 30 partners without losing control of the data.

Features in Action:

- Single link per partner guarantees the latest version.
- Per-partner PKI access prevents unauthorised forwarding.
- Access analytics reveal exactly who hasn't opened the price list in six months.

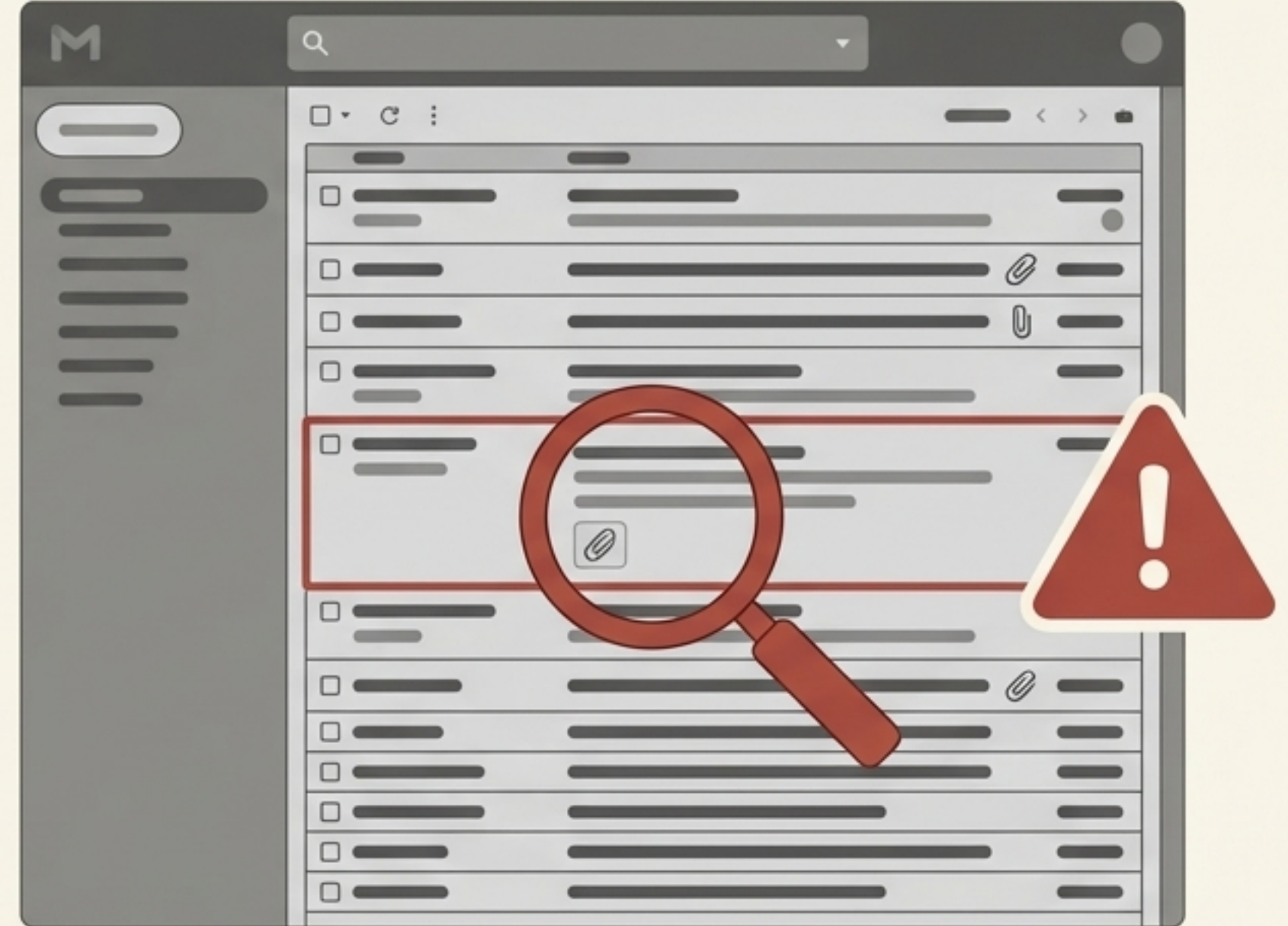


Use Case 2: The Accounts Payable Nightmare

SME accounts payable workflows are heavily reliant on email, making them highly vulnerable. Invoices mix with spam, PDFs are easily forged, and matching documents is entirely manual.

The Critical Threat: Business Email Compromise (BEC)

Attackers intercept communications and send fake invoices containing tampered bank details—costing UK businesses billions annually.

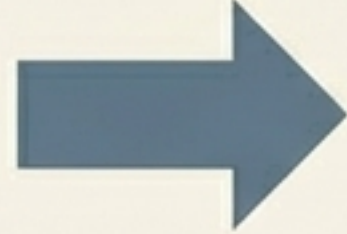


The Secure Accounts Payable Workflow



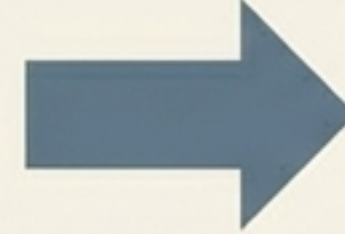
1. Onboarding

Buyer issues each supplier a specific private key and a dedicated submission link.



2. Submission

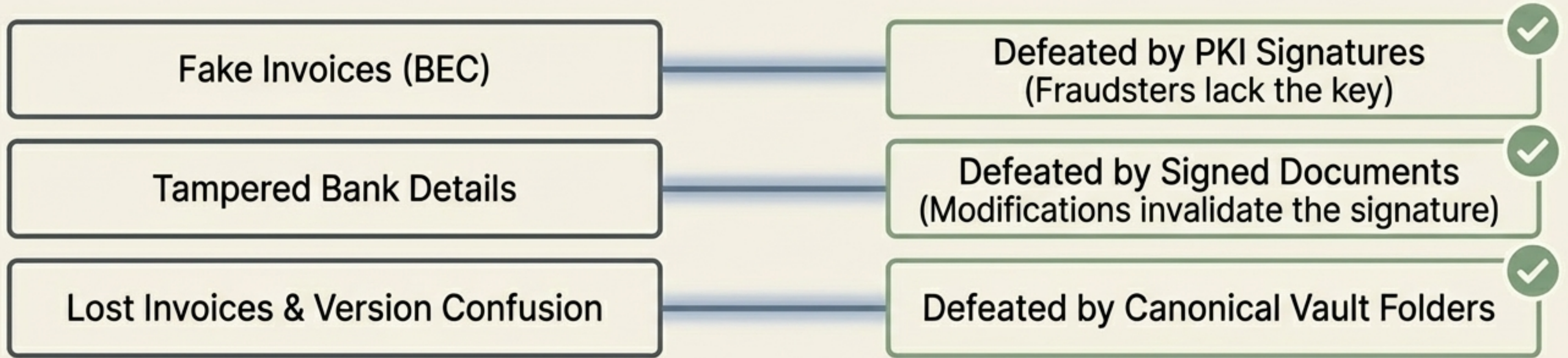
Supplier uploads the invoice to the link, digitally signing it with their private key.



3. Verification

Buyer accesses a verified, untampered invoice securely stored in their Vault folder. No email required.

Anatomy of Accounts Payable Protection



The Friction Balance

The buyer sets the process. Suppliers comply to get paid faster and more reliably. Reasonable friction ensures total security.

Use Case 3: Sensitive Executive Documents

Context:

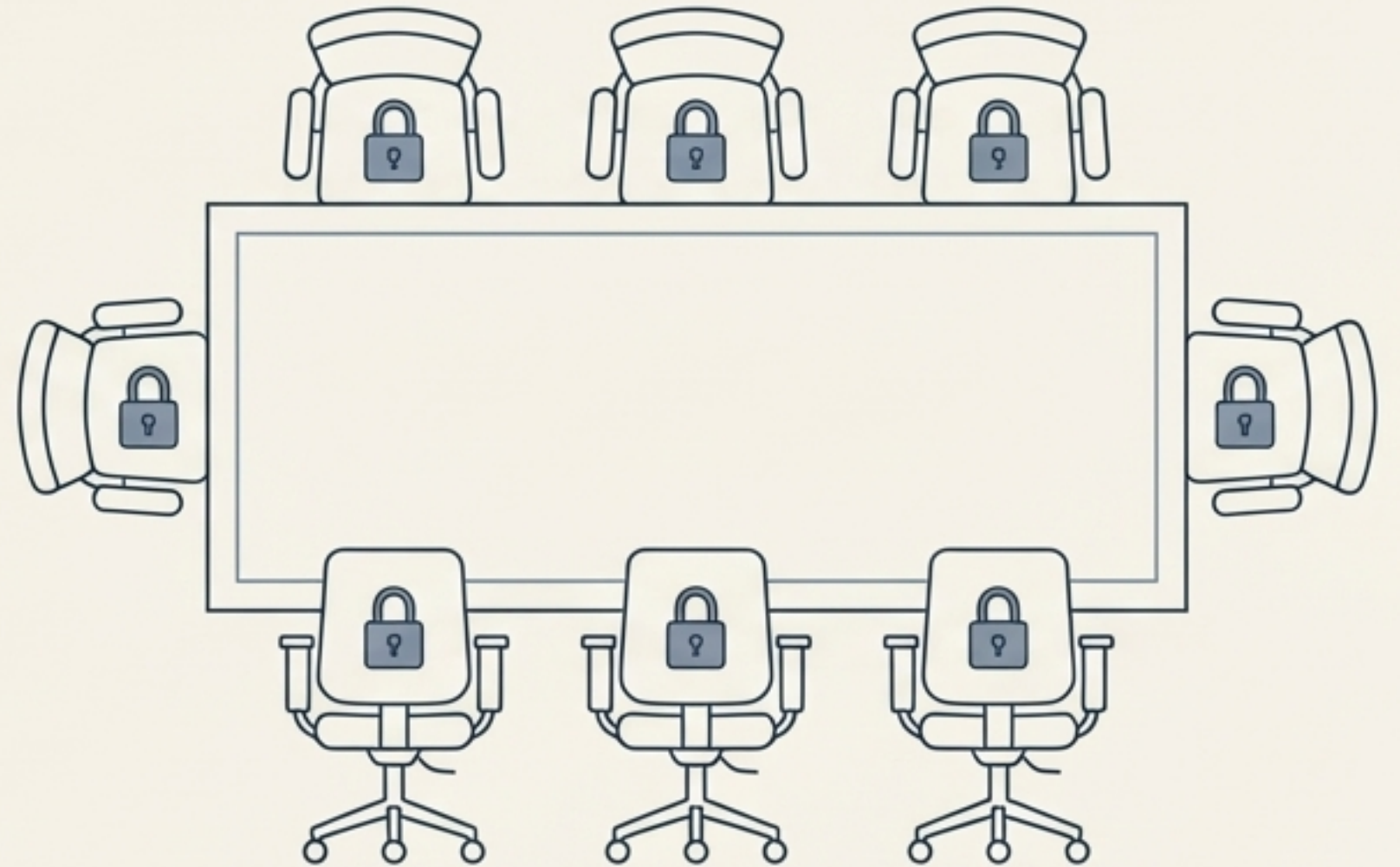
Board papers, M&A documents, financial results, and compensation data.

Execution:

Shared exclusively among small, critical groups (5-15 people).

Mechanics:

Per-recipient PKI encryption guarantees board members can only access files via their specific key. Complete visibility over who opened the file and when, combined with instant revocation capabilities.



Use Case 4: Expense Submissions & Audit Trails

Context: Secure, verifiable employee receipt and expense claims.



The Workflow:

Each employee utilises a dedicated submission link to upload receipts (photos or PDFs).

The Audit Trail:

Every submission is digitally signed (proving who submitted it) and timestamped (proving exactly when).

Documents route directly to secure, per-employee vault folders for approvers.

Content Protection: The Viewer-Based Approach

Absence of Download:

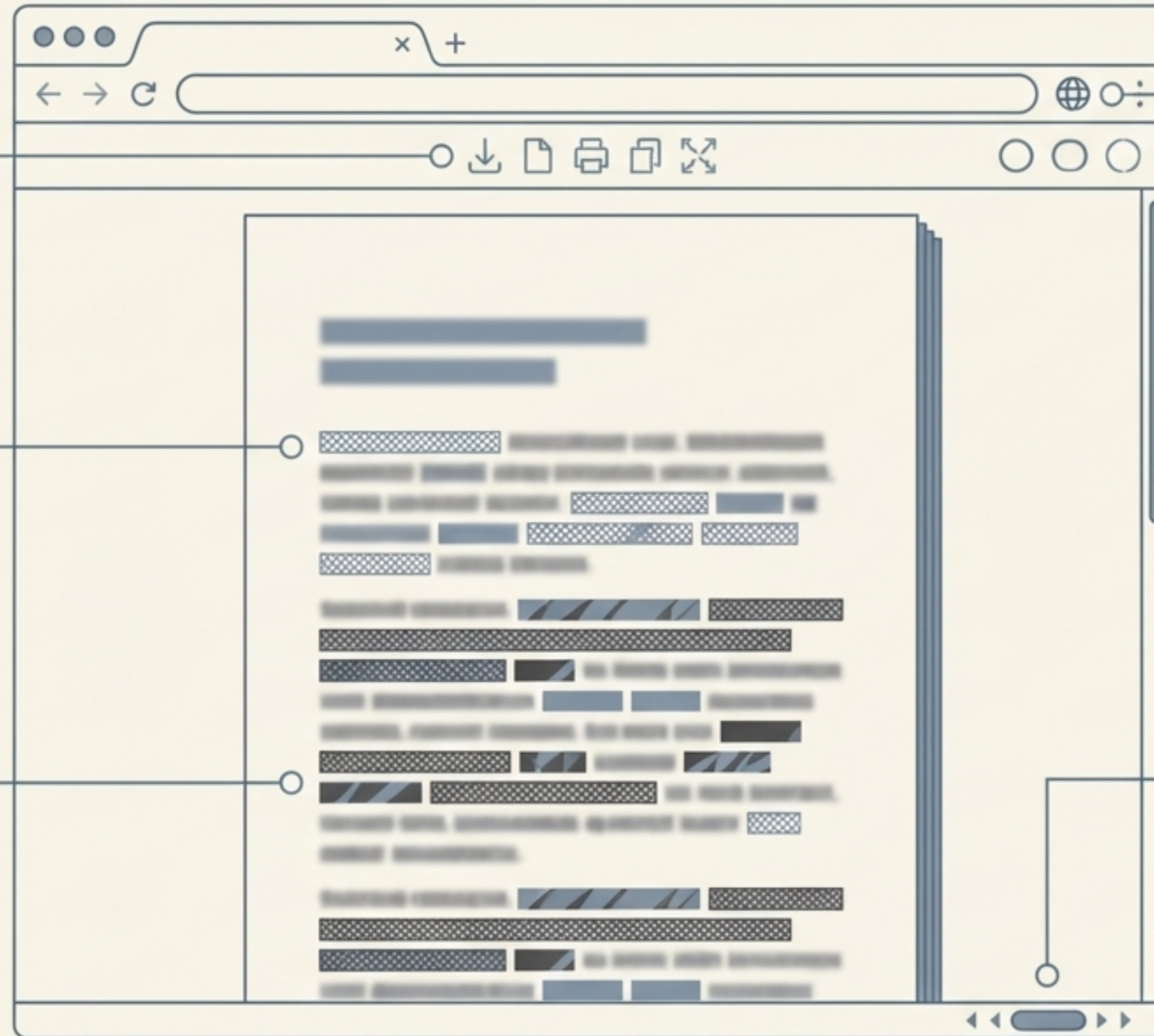
Code to save is literally absent from the sg-layout Web Components.

Disabled Controls:

Right-click and copy functions are disabled.

Scrambled Rendering:

Content is delivered visually but underlying data cannot be imported into spreadsheets.



Network Lock: Decryption keys are derived partly from the expected IP address.

Page-by-Page Loading: Each page is a separate encrypted file; no single download extracts the full document.

An Honest Threat Model



Out of Scope

We cannot prevent a determined spy from photographing a screen with their smartphone.



Perfectly Secured

- Eliminates casual forwarding (sent the price list to the wrong person).
- Prevents bulk copying (saving all 200 pages as a PDF to Dropbox).
- Maintains an ironclad audit trail for all access.

Takeaway: By making extraction harder than standard email, the path of least resistance becomes compliance.

The Business Case: Price vs. Risk Value

Manual / Email	SG/Send	Enterprise DMS
Cost: £0 direct. What You Get: No control, no audit trail, massive BEC fraud risk.	Cost: £50-£500/year (credit-based). What You Get: Encrypted sharing, canonical versioning, strict access control, complete audit trails.	Cost: £10,000-£100,000/year. What You Get: Feature-rich, but highly complex and over-engineered for SME use cases.

The Final Question

“Is £500 a year worth avoiding the next invoice fraud incident? Is it worth knowing definitively that every partner is looking at the correct price list?”

— The SME CFO

Do not compete on enterprise features. Compete on solving real risk without enterprise overkill.

Technical Foundations & Acceptance Criteria

Core Viewing & Access



- Viewer-only mode (document renders without download button via per-sender settings).

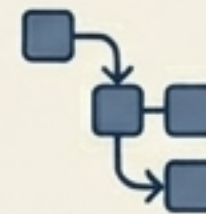


- Access analytics (tracking exactly who opened a file, when, and how often).

Cryptography & Workflows



- Per-file PKI encryption (different recipients access different files within the same share).



- Canonical version control (document updates seamlessly behind the exact same link).



- Supplier upload portals (dedicated per-supplier links for secure AP submission).